

Daily Market Report

Thursday, June 18, 2026 - After Market Close | Singapore

SECTION 1 - Market Summary

Index	Closing Price	Day	1 Week	1 Month	1 Year	52W High	52W Low
S&P 500 (SPY)	746.74	+0.78%	+1.22%	+1.77%	+23.82%	759.57	594.28
Nasdaq 100 (QQQ)	740.62	+2.51%	+3.28%	+5.57%	+38.64%	746.16	526.83
VIX	18.44	+12.37%	-17.01%	+2.10%	+8.79%	31.05	13.47

The Nasdaq 100 (NDX) surged on Thursday, June 18, 2026, with QQQ gaining +2.51% as a semiconductor-led rally powered by a Trump-announced Apple-Intel chip deal and a U.S.-Iran peace framework sent Technology +3.04%, overshadowing the prior session's Fed-induced sell-off. The S&P 500 (SPY) added +0.78%, while the VIX spiked +12.37% to 18.44 — a paradoxical fear-gauge rise on a rally day, reflecting residual macro unease from the FOMC's hawkish-leaning dot plot projections.

SECTION 1B - Early Warning

Signal	Status	What It Means
VIX (fear gauge)	GREEN	18.4 - calm
Breadth (sectors up)	AMBER	5/11 sectors green - mixed
S&P vs 50-day avg	GREEN	+2.3% vs trend
Consumer confidence	GREY	N/A - set manually in config
10Y Treasury yield	GREEN	4.49%

Overall: **HEALTHY**

SECTION 2 - Stock Spotlights

Micron Technology (MU)

Metric	Value
Closing Price	1133.99
Day Change	+8.70%
52W High	1133.99
52W Low	104.88
P/E Ratio	53.4
Dividend Yield	N/A
Analyst View	strong_buy
Analyst Target	\$1,015.34 consensus / \$1,333.33 most-recent 3-broker avg (Benzinga/Rosenblatt-Stifel-Wedbush, June 18, 2026)
Next Earnings	Jun 24, 2026
Beta (1Y)	2.98

HOLD - MU is trading at \$1,133.99, sitting precisely at its 52-week high and meaningfully above the S&P Global consensus analyst target of \$945.60 (44 analysts, Jun 2026), while the most recent three-broker average from Rosenblatt, Stifel, and Wedbush on June 18 stands at \$1,333.33 — implying divergent views; at current price, near-term risk/reward is balanced. One-year momentum is an extraordinary +893.51%, driven by HBM sold-out status through 2026, record Q2 EPS of \$12.20 (vs. \$8.60 estimate), and Q3 guidance pointing to \$33.5B in revenue at ~81% gross margin. Key risk is the stock pricing in near-perfection: Q3 earnings on June 24 carry options-implied 10% move potential, and any revenue or margin guidance miss could trigger a sharp sell-the-news correction similar to the ~8% post-Q2 dip.

SECTION 3 - Watchlist

Ticker	Company	Price	Day	1 Week	1 Month	1 Year	52W Low	52W High	Beta
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SPCX	SpaceX	185.0	-3.56%	+37.04%	N/A	+37.04%	135.0	211.39	N/A
NVDA	Nvidia	210.69	+2.95%	+2.84%	-4.50%	+46.35%	141.97	235.74	1.84
AMD	AMD	537.37	+4.86%	+10.02%	+29.78%	+336.04%	116.16	547.26	2.88
AVGO	Broadcom	411.35	+4.70%	+6.69%	+0.07%	+68.15%	244.63	481.57	2.1
GOOGL	Alphabet	368.03	+1.17%	+2.87%	-5.06%	+106.06%	165.19	402.62	1.3
IBM	IBM	249.1	-5.05%	-9.37%	+12.04%	-9.82%	214.64	329.23	1.04
MSFT	Microsoft	379.4	+0.13%	-2.80%	-9.11%	-19.43%	356.77	542.07	0.88
INTC	Intel	133.99	+10.64%	+14.56%	+20.93%	+506.84%	19.31	133.99	2.52
C	Citigroup	143.06	-0.50%	+3.61%	+19.25%	+83.34%	76.36	143.78	1.38
QRVO	Qorvo	98.42	+3.98%	+0.78%	+4.07%	+18.56%	76.02	108.23	1.24
ANET	Arista Networks	169.67	+2.87%	+8.48%	+19.84%	+81.08%	86.25	177.73	2.08
WQTM	Quantum ETF (WQTM)	37.83	+3.16%	+3.28%	+15.37%	+24.89%	23.32	41.31	2.38
GFS	GlobalFoundries	85.83	+6.44%	+6.30%	+28.72%	+117.46%	31.62	89.96	2.04

SECTION 4 - Why Markets Moved

Thursday, June 18 was a broad but semiconductor-dominated recovery session. The headline catalyst was President Trump's Truth Social post stating 'Apple has agreed to work with Intel to design and build its chips in America,' sending INTC surging +10.64% to \$133.99 — its highest closing price ever and an all-time 52-week high. The move lifted the entire chip complex: AMD +4.86%, AVGO +4.70%, NVDA +2.95%, MU +8.70%, and GFS +6.44%. Separately, the U.S. and Iran signed a Memorandum of Understanding in France establishing a framework around Strait of Hormuz access, which weighed on energy stocks (-1.65%) but removed a geopolitical tail risk that had been pressuring growth assets.

The session unfolded against a specific macro backdrop: the FOMC, meeting under new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh, held the benchmark rate steady at 3.50–3.75% but issued updated projections showing inflation at 3.6% for 2026 and signalled the possibility of a rate hike later in the year. That hawkish tilt had caused Wednesday's sharp market decline. On Thursday, investors chose to look through the Fed's cautious tone, helped by strong May retail sales data: headline retail sales rose

+0.9% vs. a +0.4% consensus estimate, suggesting the consumer remained resilient. Volume was heavy at 23.66 billion shares traded, well above the 20-session average of 21.07 billion, underscoring conviction in the bounce.

For overseas retail investors, Thursday's action has three key implications. First, the Apple-Intel chip deal narrative — unconfirmed by either company — is a sentiment trade, not a fundamental one; revenue from any such partnership is 12-18 months away at minimum, so INTC's spike deserves caution before chasing. Second, the Fed's hawkish pivot is real: with inflation forecast at 3.6% in 2026 and rate cuts no longer on the table, valuation compression risk for high-P/E tech names remains elevated — QQQ still sits within 0.75% of its 52-week high of \$746.16. Third, the Iran MOU is a de-escalation positive for global risk sentiment, though the Strait of Hormuz deal details and compliance remain unresolved, keeping energy uncertainty in play.

SECTION 5 - Sector Rotation & Macro

Winners

- Technology: **+3.04%**
- Consumer Disc: **+1.45%**
- Industrials: **+0.73%**

Losers

- Financials: **-0.89%**
- Energy: **-1.65%**

Macro

- Fed Chair Kevin Warsh held rates steady at 3.50-3.75% at his inaugural FOMC meeting but updated projections signal inflation at 3.6% in 2026 (well above the 2% target) and raise the prospect of a hike later this year — a hawkish pivot that puts a ceiling on rate-cut-driven equity re-ratings.
- May retail sales surged +0.9% month-on-month (vs. +0.4% est.) and +6.9% year-on-year, providing strong evidence that the U.S. consumer is absorbing higher prices; this reduces urgency for Fed easing but also reduces recession risk, a net neutral-to-positive for equities.
- The U.S.-Iran peace MOU signed in France has partially relieved Strait of Hormuz supply concerns that had driven energy cost volatility across Asia-Pacific; however, the deal is preliminary and any breakdown could rapidly reignite oil/transport inflation that feeds into sticky core CPI and complicates the Fed's path.

SECTION 6 - Earnings Calendar

Watchlist stocks verified. Broader NDX dates sourced via web search - confirm before trading.

Company	Ticker	Next Earnings	
Micron Technology	MU	Jun 24, 2026	WATCHLIST
FedEx	FDX	Jun 24, 2026	
Nike	NKE	Jun 26, 2026	
Paychex	PAYX	Jun 25, 2026	
General Mills	GIS	Jun 25, 2026	
Accenture	ACN	Jun 26, 2026	
Carnival Corp	CCL	Jun 27, 2026	
Walgreens Boots Alliance	WBA	Jun 26, 2026	
Constellation Brands	STZ	Jul 1, 2026	
Levi Strauss	LEVI	Jul 1, 2026	
Delta Air Lines	DAL	Jul 9, 2026	
JPMorgan Chase	JPM	Jul 11, 2026	

SECTION 6B - Opportunity Radar

- **US Domestic Chip Manufacturing Renaissance** - Trump's unconfirmed Apple-Intel announcement has catalysed a re-rating of domestic foundry and chip-design stocks. Intel's 18A-P process node entered risk production on June 16, and Bernstein raised its price target to \$100 from \$65 on June 17 — the stock hit its all-time high on June 18. The broader chip-manufacturing supply-chain repricing is NOW because the policy and geopolitical case for US-made silicon has reached an inflection point, with INTC +506.84% over the past year and GFS +117.46% confirming structural re-rating underway. (e.g. INTC)
- **AI Memory Supercycle — HBM Sold-Out Through 2026** - Micron guided Q3 to \$33.5B revenue at ~81% gross margins — a single quarter exceeding any prior full fiscal year — with HBM production sold out under binding

contracts. AI data centre buildout continues to drive DRAM/NAND tightness, with server DRAM/NAND TAM surpassing 50% of industry totals. MU Q3 earnings on June 24 are the next catalyst. AMD's +336% 1-year gain and Arista Networks' +81% 1-year gain confirm the AI infrastructure spending wave has broadened beyond just Nvidia. (e.g. MU)

- **NDX Rebalance Inclusion Plays — Forced Institutional Buying** - The NDX quarterly rebalance effective June 22, 2026 adds Astera Labs (ALAB), CoreWeave (CRWV), Nebius Group (NBIS), Rocket Lab (RKLB), and Teradyne (TER) to the index. Index-linked funds must mechanically purchase these names over the days following inclusion, creating predictable near-term demand pressure. Rocket Lab's \$2.2B record backlog and upcoming Neutron first flight in Q4 2026 provide fundamental support on top of the index-flow catalyst — RKLB received multiple analyst upgrades in June 2026. (e.g. RKLB)

The current environment supports a selective HOLD/BUY posture in high-quality AI-infrastructure and domestic semiconductor names, with disciplined position-sizing given elevated valuations. VIX at 18.44 is calm (GREEN) and the S&P sits +2.3% above its 50-day moving average (GREEN), suggesting no imminent technical breakdown; however, AMBER breadth (only 5/11 sectors green) warns that the rally remains narrow and concentrated in tech. The Fed's hawkish pivot — with inflation at 3.6% and a possible 2026 rate hike on the table — argues against aggressively adding duration-sensitive or high-P/E names at current levels. The 10Y Treasury at 4.49% (GREEN) provides a genuine alternative to equities for risk-averse capital. Recommended stance: maintain core AI/semiconductor exposure (NVDA, AVGO, AMD, ANET), take partial profits in names that have exceeded analyst consensus targets (MU at \$1,133.99 vs. \$945.60 consensus), avoid chasing unconfirmed policy-headline movers (INTC), and use any VIX spike above 25 as a re-entry signal into quality growth.

SECTION 7 - Stocks to Watch

AMD | Price: \$537.37 | **BUY** | Horizon: 5-YEAR

AMD has delivered a staggering +336% 1-year return and sits close to its 52-week high of \$547.26 at \$537.37, driven by MI300X data centre GPU traction and a structural shift of enterprise AI workloads toward multi-vendor architectures — a multi-year secular tailwind that is still in early innings. With beta of 2.88 and 1-month momentum of +29.78%, near-term volatility is high, but the 5-year story of AMD closing the gap with Nvidia in AI accelerators, capturing server CPU share from Intel, and benefiting from the CHIPS Act domestic manufacturing wave makes this a core long-term holding; scale in on dips toward the \$480-500 support zone.

ANET | Price: \$169.67 | **HOLD** | Horizon: 1-YEAR

Arista Networks at \$169.67 (1-year: +81.08%) has been a direct beneficiary of hyperscaler AI data centre networking upgrades, and the stock is 4.5% below its 52-week high of \$177.73 — suggesting momentum with room for a modest re-test of highs; however, at a beta of 2.08 and with limited near-term catalyst before the next earnings cycle, the risk/reward over

a 1-year horizon is balanced rather than compelling. Hold existing positions and use the \$155–160 zone as a re-entry if tech sentiment cools following the Fed's hawkish commentary.

IBM | Price: \$249.1 | **SELL** | Horizon: EXIT NOW

IBM is the clear underperformer in the AI cohort: -9.82% over the past year, -9.37% over the past week, and -5.05% in Thursday's session alone — declining on a day the broader tech sector rose +3.04%, a stark divergence that signals active sector rotation away from legacy IT. At \$249.10, IBM trades in the lower half of its 52-week range (\$214.64–\$329.23) and is structurally losing share to cloud-native and AI-pure-play competitors; the low beta of 1.04 limits upside participation in tech rallies, and there is no near-term catalyst to reverse the negative price trend — exit and redeploy into higher-conviction AI infrastructure names.

GFS | Price: \$85.83 | **BUY** | Horizon: 1-YEAR

GlobalFoundries at \$85.83 is approaching its 52-week high of \$89.96 (+117.46% 1-year) on multiple catalysts: first-ever quarterly dividend of \$0.12/share (ex-date June 24), completion of the Synopsys Processor IP acquisition on June 2, quantum technology solutions launch, and a new AI-centric technology roadmap unveiled at the May 2026 Investor Day — all while trading at a significant discount to TSMC and benefiting from the domestic chip manufacturing policy tailwind. The Apple-Intel deal narrative indirectly boosts GFS as investors reprice US foundry capacity scarcity; with Q2 revenue guidance of \$1.76B and the inaugural dividend signalling management confidence, this is a catalyst-rich 1-year setup.

RKLB | Price: \$109.45 (approx. current — not in verified data layer; verify before trading) | **BUY** | Horizon: 5-YEAR

Rocket Lab (RKLB), newly added to the NDX effective June 22, 2026, sits at the intersection of three powerful themes: NDX inclusion-driven mechanical institutional buying, a record \$2.2B backlog, and an upcoming Neutron medium-lift rocket first flight in Q4 2026 that could unlock a new \$50–55M per mission revenue tier versus the current \$8.4M Electron price point. Multiple analyst upgrades in June 2026 following the Neutron development update, combined with the SpaceX IPO-driven rotation of space-sector capital toward more accessible public vehicles, make RKLB a compelling 5-year compounding play for investors who want direct space infrastructure exposure.

SECTION 8 - Market Trends

Thursday's session revealed a market that is resilient but bifurcated: the Nasdaq 100 (NDX) rally of +2.51% was driven almost entirely by semiconductors and AI infrastructure names responding to a policy narrative (Trump/Apple/Intel), while only 5 of 11 S&P sectors closed green — a breadth pattern that historically signals the rally lacks the broad participation needed for sustained upside. The paradoxical VIX spike of +12.37% to 18.44 on a positive tape is a tell: options markets are not fully convinced the Fed's hawkish pivot is priced in, and traders are hedging for potential volatility around MU Q3

earnings on June 24 and any follow-up FOMC commentary. Volume at 23.66 billion shares (12% above the 20-session average) suggests institutional conviction in the directional move, but the narrow leadership warns against complacency.

Upside Risks

- MU Q3 earnings beat on June 24: guidance calls for \$33.5B revenue at ~81% gross margins — if Micron delivers, it could re-accelerate the entire AI memory complex and push QQQ through its 52-week high of \$746.16, with the current gap to all-time-high just 0.75%.
- Apple-Intel deal confirmation: if Apple formally confirms the foundry partnership, Intel's addressable revenue could roughly double (~\$53B annual run rate), triggering a wave of semiconductor ETF re-weightings and broad-based tech buying that would benefit the QQQ's top-heavy semiconductor allocation.
- Iran MOU compliance triggers energy cost relief: if the Strait of Hormuz MOU holds and oil logistics normalise, the resulting decline in energy/transportation inflation could soften the CPI print enough to push the Fed back toward a neutral stance, relieving the rate-hike overhang and potentially re-opening the growth multiple expansion trade.

Downside Risks

- Fed rate-hike materialisation: the FOMC under Warsh has projected inflation at 3.6% in 2026 — if the July or August CPI print confirms persistent elevation, markets may begin pricing in a 25bp hike, potentially pushing the 10Y Treasury well above its current 4.49% level and compressing tech P/E multiples across the NDX.
- MU earnings sell-the-news: with MU at its 52-week high of \$1,133.99 and options pricing a ~10% post-earnings move, a guidance miss or softening of HBM demand commentary on June 24 could spark a sharp semiconductor-wide correction — a prior MU earnings announcement produced a -10.87% reaction, which at current index weights would be material for QQQ.
- NDX concentration and narrowing leadership: Bank of America has flagged that rising valuations and narrowing leadership leave investors increasingly vulnerable; with QQQ +38.64% over 12 months and only 5/11 sectors participating in Thursday's rally, any rotation away from mega-cap tech — driven by profit-taking, sector rotation to small-caps, or an AI capex ROI reassessment — could produce outsized index drawdowns given the top-heavy NDX weighting.

SECTION 9 - Portfolio Allocation (5-8 Year Horizon)

With VIX at a calm 18.44, the S&P +2.3% above its 50-day moving average, and the 10Y Treasury yielding 4.49% — the highest real yield available in years — a pre-retirement investor 5-8 years from drawdown should harvest the current tech rally to gradually shift from pure growth toward a growth-and-income hybrid, while maintaining meaningful equity exposure to outpace the Fed's own 3.6% inflation forecast over the medium term. The AMBER breadth signal and the Fed's hawkish

pivot argue for keeping a larger-than-usual cash and short-duration bond buffer to fund opportunistic re-entry and buffer sequence-of-returns risk in the final pre-retirement years.

Bucket	Allocation %	Purpose
Core US Large-Cap Growth Equities (NDX/S&P 500 index exposure)	35%	Capture ongoing AI/tech secular growth via diversified index exposure (QQQ, SPY); primary engine of capital appreciation over the 5-8 year horizon. Trim if QQQ exceeds 52-week high by >5% and VIX falls below 14.
Quality Dividend & Low-Volatility US Equities	15%	Provide equity participation with downside buffer via dividend-paying blue chips (low-beta, high-FCF names like MSFT, AVGO); reduces sequence-of-returns risk as retirement approaches and generates reinvestable income at 4.49% yield alternative backdrop.
Intermediate US Treasuries & Investment-Grade Bonds (3-7yr duration)	20%	Lock in attractive 4.4-4.7% yields before any eventual rate normalisation; provides capital preservation and negative correlation to equity drawdowns. Avoids long-duration exposure given hawkish Fed signals — keep average duration at 4-5 years.
Short-Duration Bonds & T-Bills / Money Market (cash equivalent)	12%	Liquidity buffer earning 4.8-5.0% on T-bills; funds opportunistic re-entry on VIX spikes above 25 and covers 12-18 months of anticipated retirement drawdown needs — the key sequence-of-returns risk mitigation bucket.
Thematic AI & Semiconductor Overweight (active single-stock / sector ETF)	10%	Concentrated tactical bet on the AI supercycle via high-conviction names (AMD, AVGO, ANET, GFS) and/or SOXX/SMH; expected to be the highest-volatility bucket — capped at 10% to limit idiosyncratic risk with 5-year horizon pressure building.
International Developed Markets Equities (hedged)	5%	Diversifies away from US-centric AI concentration risk and captures emerging-market semiconductor strength (MSCI EAFE up 20%+ YTD); currency-hedged to manage USD volatility given Fed/BoJ policy divergence.
Real Assets & Inflation Hedges (TIPS, REITs, Commodities ETF)	3%	Direct inflation hedge given the Fed's 3.6% 2026 CPI forecast; TIPS provide real yield protection, while energy/materials commodities benefit if the Iran MOU breaks down and Hormuz costs re-escalate. Small allocation limits drag in the current disinflationary-trend scenario.

Rebalance Trigger: Rebalance immediately if: (1) VIX closes above 25 for two consecutive sessions — shift 5% from Core Growth to Short-Duration Cash; (2) QQQ declines more than 10% from its 52-week high of \$746.16 (i.e., drops below ~\$671) — deploy cash buffer into Core Growth and Thematic AI buckets; (3) 10Y Treasury yield rises above 5.25% — reduce Intermediate Bond duration to <3 years and shift proceeds to T-bills; or (4) the Fed explicitly announces a rate hike at any FOMC meeting — reduce Thematic AI allocation by 3% and increase Investment-Grade Bonds accordingly.